enormous trade show. It will be jam-packed with the newest woodturning products, tool and lathe manufacturers and supplies. You'll be able to observe a range of ongoing demonstrations, hold tools in your own hands, see tricks and techniques, and kick some tires. Bring an extra suitcase…

Lifelong connections

AAW's symposium is a chance to step out of your workshop and tap into the greater woodturning community. With a culture of co-operation, camaraderie and sharing, you'll be able to gain knowledge and find friendships that will last a lifetime, establish and renew connections and schmooze a bit!

World's largest display of turned-wood items

Whatever your skill level, you can bring up to three pieces of your work to display in our huge 'Instant Gallery' and participate in the largest show of turned-wood objects under one roof. Our themed exhibits, Turning 30 and Patterns, will draw collectors and galleries from around the country. You'll be inspired by the selection of exhibition work and have an opportunity for your own work to get noticed.

Give back to others

Passionate woodturners are often equally as concerned with 'paying it forward' and AAW's symposium offers many opportunities to support charitable causes, including Empty Bowls, Beads of Courage and AAW's own Tool Bank, education and outreach programmes. Donate or purchase a turned item to benefit a charitable cause. Bid high in our auctions to support woodturning education and outreach programmes. It's good karma.

Affordable family activities

Turners will find that their families and friends receive a warm welcome. AAW's Youth Program offers free instructor-led, hands-on woodturning instruction for kids aged 10 to 18 – free with a paid adult, pre-registration required. You'll be able to sow the seeds for a lifelong love of woodturning that will leave lasting memories for a child or grandchild. Your registered non-turner spouse, partner, or adult guest is invited to participate in a variety of creative activities and tours while you attend woodturning rotations through AAW's Companion Program in addition to browsing our exhibitions, galleries and tradeshow.

Of course, visitors can also explore Atlanta – birthplace of *Gone with the Wind*, Martin Luther King, Jr. and Coca-Cola. The city and its surrounding area is beautiful and surprisingly lush with trees – magnolias, dogwoods, southern pines, magnificent oaks and the peach tree. It is also famous for its Southern charm and offers inexpensive fun for families, older adults and everyone in between.

Learn more about AAW's 30th Annual Symposium at tiny.cc/AAW2016Atlanta

TERRY MARTIN, a woodturner who hails from Australia, says: "For me, the AAW is a wonderful extension of my woodturning family. Each year as I travel to the US for the annual gathering I know I am going to compress an outrageous amount of social value into the few days I am there. I will meet amazing new turners and refresh distance-strained old friendships. In the Instant Gallery, I will see wonderful pieces of both turned art and traditional turning in what remains the largest single exhibition of woodturning in the world..."

When asked what it's like for a non-American attending an AAW symposium, Terry explains: "The overwhelming impression is of good will and generous welcomes, in a well-run environment. Americans are invariably kind to visiting turners and it is this, more than anything else that always makes it a good experience. For me, the most important thing is the networking. I've learned that if you sit in one place long enough, every person you know or have ever wanted to know, will probably pass by... For foreigners from a more modest scene this symposium can be a mix of the Oscars and Disneyland. A journey to the symposium can be a trip of a lifetime and something to tell stories about..."

'Gold Nouveau Bowl' at around 60mm x 310mm, by Jason The Turner

'Silver Plated Baron Pen' by Walter Hall. In Shades of Grey mesh acrylic upgraded with a Bock nib and Beaufort ink converter

In memory of Miguel López

A wonderful teacher

It is with deep sadness we report that Miguel López, owner of Tornyfusta in Palma de Mallorca, passed away in November. Our thoughts are with his family at this time.

Miguel was a man with a passion for turning and he did all he could to encourage and help people to turn. His video clips on the internet are widely viewed and he always enjoyed meeting new people and sharing ideas. Miguel always had a smile on his face when I met him at events. The turning world has lost a wonderful teacher and advocate for all things turning.

Mark Baker, Editor, Woodturning

Popular face

It was very sad news indeed to learn of the passing of our good friend Miguel.

He was such a big voice in Spanish woodturning and his efforts in translating and making videos to expand the knowledge on the subject will take some beating.

Miguel's business, Tornyfusta, runs from a small but well-stocked unit in Palma, and over the years he took the company to many cities in Spain with his son Xavi. I first met Miguel at an Axminster show in the UK but demonstrated with him at several other events, as did many other British turners including Phil Irons, Colwin Way and Mick Hanbury. He was a popular face on the woodturning cruise and loved by anyone who met him. RIP Miguel. We will all miss you.

Nick Agar, woodturning artist, Devon

Loyal and generous

Miguel was a loyal and pleasant man who we really enjoyed working with. Over the past 10 years his business has grown with us as well as our friendship. A generous host and pleasant person; we will miss him. Our condolences to all his family and friends.

Jim Preston and all the BriMarc team

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